



Official website of the Department of Homeland Security

On July 17, 2026, DHS [published](#) a final rule establishing a fixed time period for academic students, J exchange visitors and representatives of foreign institutions.

Homeland
Security**STUDY** in the **STATES**

STUDENTS

SCHOOLS

BLOG



SEVIS HELP HUB

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Complete Program

COMPLETE PROGRAM

Last updated: March 6, 2020

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F/M Status

F/M Student

When F-1 or M-1 students finish their programs of study and/or post-completion practical training (employment), they have a grace period during which they can do the following:

F-1 Student 60-day Grace Period	M-1 Student 30-day Grace Period
• Apply and be accepted to a new academic program to start within five months • Apply to United States Citizenship and Immigration Services (USCIS) for a change of class of admission • Travel within the United States and make preparations to depart by the end of the grace period	• Apply to United States Citizenship and Immigration Services for a change of class of admission • Travel within the United States and make preparations to depart by the end of the grace period

SEVIS auto-completes the student’s record after the appropriate grace period has passed. However, the student may not depart and return to the United States during the grace period. If the student departs the United States before the end of this grace period, the rest of the grace period is lost.

Employment

Manage Program Dates, Registration and Course Load

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SEVIS Basics

School Records



Before a DSO manually completes a SEVIS record, the DSO should confirm that the student is outside the United States. Once a SEVIS record is in Completed status:

- The grace period is no longer available.
- The record cannot be reactivated without one of the following:
- An SEVP-adjudicated correction request
- A USCIS-adjudicated reinstatement application

It is important for DSOs to understand the difference between completing a program and shortening a program. DSOs shorten a program when the student completes the program of study earlier than the anticipated program end date in SEVIS. Shortening the program still allows for the grace period. See the SEVIS Help Hub article [Shorten F-1/M-1 Program](#).

Completing F-1 or M-1 Program in SEVIS

To complete the student's record in SEVIS:

1. Navigate to the *Student Information* page.

2. Click **Complete Program** link under the Actions section. The *Complete Program* page opens.

Note: The *Complete Program* page allows users to view and enter required information on a student's program completion.

- Enter comments in the **Remarks** field regarding the student's program completion.
- Click button at the bottom of the page to complete the process:
 - **Complete Program:** Submits the completion information and opens a *Confirm* page that requires a response:
 - **Yes:** Confirms you want to change the status of the student to Completed



Once the student's record is completed, you will not be able to take any action on this student or print the student's record without requesting reinstatement.

- **No:** Cancels the completion process and returns to the *Student Information* page.
 - **Reset Values:** Deletes any information in the Remarks field and remains on the *Complete Program* page.
 - **Cancel:** Cancels the completion process and returns to the *Student Information* page.
- Upon successfully submitting the completion record, DSOs can return to the view record or print the student's Form I-20.

Correcting Student Status

If a DSO completes a student's record in error, they must submit a correction request in SEVIS to address the error.

Refer to [Change to Student Status](#) article on the SEVIS Help Hub to learn more about correcting student status.

WHAT'S NEW

Try the Facebook Chatbot

Visit the tool on the Study in the States Facebook page to learn how to become an F or M international student in the United States.

[Read more on the blog](#)

Learn About Summer Employment

While employed this summer, make sure you have all the relevant information on maintaining your student status, and the steps you must take before returning to school.

[Read more on the blog](#)

ICON GUIDE

See the [SEVIS Help Icons](#) on the SEVIS Help Hub for a quick-reference of the icons used in this user guide.

I'm Looking For

CONTACT US

SEVP Response
Center

703-603-3400

Monday -Friday
8:00 a.m. to 6:00
p.m. ET,
except holidays

SEVP@ice.dhs.gov

ICE Tip Line

[1-866-DHS-2-ICE](tel:1-866-DHS-2-ICE)

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